TEXAS STAAR

GRADE 8

Reading Language Arts & Mathematics

All-in-One Study & Practice Guide

8 Full-Length Practice Tests · Complete Skill Review · Deep Answer Explanations

Short & Extended Constructed Response Mastery · Score Diagnostics

100% aligned to the Texas Essential Knowledge and Skills (TEKS)

2027 EDITION

Adrian Ross

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All passages, questions, graphics, and practice materials in this book are **original works** created for instructional practice. They are designed to reflect the style, format, difficulty, and standards coverage of the STAAR Grade 8 assessment; they are **not** actual test questions and are **not** reproduced from any secure or released state testing material.

About This Edition

This 2027 Edition reflects the STAAR program **as of November 5, 2026**, including the online test format and the current question types, scoring, and TEKS blueprint. Under Texas House Bill 8 (2025), **spring 2027 is the final STAAR administration** for grades 3–8; a new assessment, the Student Success Tool, is scheduled to replace STAAR beginning in the 2027–2028 school year. This book is built to prepare students thoroughly for that final STAAR year.

While every effort has been made to ensure accuracy, test specifications can change. Families and educators should confirm current details on the official Texas Education Agency website.

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How this book is organized: First you *learn* each tested skill, then you *practice* it in short drills, then you *simulate* the real test with eight full-length practice tests, and finally you *diagnose* your results to see exactly what to study next.

Welcome to Your STAAR Grade 8 Study Guide

Dear Student,

The STAAR Grade 8 tests in Reading Language Arts and Mathematics can feel like a lot — two subjects, many skills, a timed online screen, and even written essays. This book exists to make all of that feel familiar long before test day.

Here is the promise of this book: **everything inside is on the test, and nothing on the test is left out.** Every lesson, every practice question, and every writing prompt is tied directly to the Texas Essential Knowledge and Skills (TEKS) that STAAR measures at Grade 8. You will not waste a single minute on material that will not help you.

You will move through four stages:

1. **Learn** — short, clear lessons that teach every tested skill.
2. **Practice** — quick drills so each skill sticks.
3. **Simulate** — eight full-length practice tests that look and feel like the real thing.
4. **Diagnose** — answer explanations and charts that show you exactly what to review next.

Work at a steady pace, check every answer explanation (even for questions you got right), and use the diagnostic charts to spend your study time where it matters most. Confidence on test day comes from practice, and this book gives you plenty.

You can do this. Let's get started.

— *Adrian Ross*

A note for parents and teachers: A full guide for supporting a student with this book — including how to read the diagnostic charts and how to coach the written responses — begins on the "A Guide for Parents and Teachers" page near the back.

How to Use This Book

This book works for three kinds of readers. Find the path that fits you.

Path A — The Student Studying on Your Own

1. **Start with "Getting Started."** Read how the test works, how it is scored, and how the online question types look on paper. About 30 minutes — and it saves you from surprises.
2. **Pick a study calendar.** Use the 4-Week Sprint if the test is close, or the 8-Week Plan if you have more time.
3. **Learn, then practice.** Read the skill lessons and do the warm-up drills before a full test.
4. **Take one full test at a time, under test-like conditions** — quiet room, no phone, timed.
5. **Review every explanation,** including for questions you answered correctly.
6. **Fill in your diagnostic chart** after each test, then study your weakest strand next.

Path B — The Parent or Tutor Helping a Student

- Use the **"A Guide for Parents and Teachers"** section at the back first.
- Sit with the student for the **first** practice test to model pacing, then let them work more independently.
- Focus praise on **effort and strategy**, not just the score. The tracking sheets make growth visible.

Path C — The Classroom Teacher

- Lessons and drills map one-to-one to the **TEKS**; the **TEKS Coverage Index** lists where every standard is taught and practiced.
- Each full-length test is blueprint-matched — usable as a benchmark or mock administration.
- Explanations include the TEKS code and *why each wrong choice is wrong*, useful for reteaching.

The Symbols You Will See

Symbol	Meaning
★	**Readiness standard** — tested heavily every year. Master these first.
○	**Supporting standard** — tested less often, but still fair game.

Key Idea	The one thing to remember from a lesson.
Watch Out	A common Grade 8 mistake to avoid.
Try It	A quick practice item to check yourself.
Strategy	A test-taking tip tied to the question in front of you.

Tip: Keep a pencil, scratch paper, and the Grade 8 Mathematics Reference Sheet nearby while you work. On the real test these tools are available to you — practice using them now.

Inside the STAAR Grade 8 Test

The Final STAAR Year

STAAR — the State of Texas Assessments of Academic Readiness — measures how well students have learned the **Texas Essential Knowledge and Skills (TEKS)** for their grade. Under Texas House Bill 8 (2025), **spring 2027 is the last STAAR administration** for grades 3–8. A new assessment called the Student Success Tool is scheduled to replace it in 2027–2028. This book prepares you fully for that final STAAR year.

A Computer-Based Test

STAAR is given **online**, on a computer. The real test includes question types beyond simple multiple choice — you might type an answer, choose from a drop-down menu, drag items into place, or build an equation. A paper book can't make you click and drag, so this book does the next best thing: it **shows every online question type on paper** and teaches you exactly how to answer it. The *thinking* is identical; only the clicking is different.

What Grade 8 Students Take

At Grade 8, students are assessed in **Reading Language Arts, Mathematics, Science, and Social Studies.** This book focuses on the two taken by every Grade 8 student every year: **Reading Language Arts and Mathematics.**

The Mathematics Test at a Glance

Feature	Grade 8 Mathematics
Total questions	**40**
Total points	**48** (32 one-point + 8 two-point questions)
Reporting categories (strands)	4 — Numerical; Computations & Algebraic; Geometry & Measurement; Data & Financial Literacy
Question types	Multiple choice, multiselect, inline choice, text entry/griddable, drag-and-drop, equation editor, graphing
Tools provided	**Calculator** and the **Grade 8 Mathematics Reference Sheet**

The Reading Language Arts Test at a Glance

Feature	Grade 8 Reading Language Arts
Total questions	**~45**
Total points	**56**
Reading section	~28 questions / ~30 points — includes **2 Short Constructed Responses** (2 pts each)
Writing section (Revising & Editing)	~17 questions / ~26 points — includes **1 Extended Constructed Response** (10 pts)
Passages	Literary and informational; single passages and a paired set
Tools provided	Online **dictionary/thesaurus**

How Much Time?

STAAR for grades 3–8 is given with a generous time window of **up to four hours**. It is **not a speed test** — most students finish comfortably. Still, practicing with a timer builds a steady, calm pace.

> **Watch Out:** Written responses carry real points — up to **14 of the 56 RLA points** come from the SCRs and ECR. Never leave them blank. A partial, organized response almost always earns more than nothing.

How STAAR Is Scored

From Raw Points to a Performance Level

Each question earns **raw points** (1 or 2 for most; the Extended Constructed Response is worth 10). Your total raw points convert to a **scale score**, which places you in one of four **performance levels**:

Performance Level	What It Means
Masters Grade Level	Strong command of the grade's content; ready for the next grade with little support.
Meets Grade Level	Solid understanding; likely to succeed next grade with some support.
Approaches Grade Level	Some understanding; likely needs targeted support next grade.
Did Not Meet Grade Level	Not enough understanding yet; needs significant support.

The goal for most students is **Meets Grade Level** or higher — and this book is built to get you there.

How Written Responses Are Scored

- **Short Constructed Response (SCR)** — a few sentences answering a specific question, scored **0 to 2 points**. Earn full credit by making a clear point and backing it with correct **evidence from the text**.
- **Extended Constructed Response (ECR)** — a full multi-paragraph essay, scored **0 to 10 points**. The rubric rewards a clear central idea or claim, organized paragraphs, specific supporting evidence, and correct language and conventions.

You will learn to earn these points step by step in the **SCR Mastery** and **ECR Mastery** sections, which include real-style prompts and sample responses scored at high, middle, and low levels.

Tracking Your Own Scores

After each practice test, use the **Score-Tracking Sheets** and **Strand Diagnostic Charts** at the back. They turn raw points into a performance estimate and show you **which strand or skill to study next.** Watching your scores climb from Test 1 to Test 4 is the clearest sign your work is paying off.

Item-Type Field Guide

How Online Questions Look on Paper

STAAR is taken on a computer, so some questions ask you to do more than bubble a letter. This guide shows **every question type you may meet**, how we present it on paper in this book, and a quick example. The skill tested is always a Grade 8 TEKS skill — only the way you record your answer changes.

> **Key Idea:** On screen you *click, type, or drag.* On paper you *circle, write, or draw an arrow.* The thinking is exactly the same.

1. Multiple Choice

Online: Click one choice (A–D). **On paper:** Circle the letter of the one best answer.

Example (Math). Which number is the greatest? A. 0.6 B. ⅗ C. 0.58 D. ½ *(Answer: A)*

2. Multiselect

Online: Check every correct box. **On paper:** Circle **all** correct letters; the question says how many.

Example (Math). Select the **two** numbers that are irrational. A. √49 B. √10 C. π D. 0.25 *(Answers: B and C)*

3. Inline Choice (Drop-Down)

Online: Click a drop-down inside the sentence. **On paper:** Each drop-down is a box of choices; circle the correct one.

Example (Revising & Editing). The science club meets after school, and the members [is / **are** / was] planning a fundraiser. *(Answer: are)*

4. Text Entry / Griddable

Online: Type a number or short answer; for numbers you may fill a grid. **On paper:** Write in the box, then bubble the grid when provided.

Example (Math). A line passes through (0, 3) with slope 2. What is y when $x = 4$? [ ] *(Answer: 11)*

5. Drag-and-Drop

Online: Drag words/numbers from a bank into blanks or an order. **On paper:** A bank is printed; write each item on the correct line or draw an arrow.

Example (Math). Order from **least to greatest.** Bank: 0.4, ⅓, 0.37, ⅖ Least __ __ __ __ Greatest *(Answer: ⅓, 0.37, 0.4, ⅖)*

6. Equation Editor

Online: Build an expression/equation with an on-screen keypad. **On paper:** Write it neatly on the line.

Example (Math). Write an equation in form $y = mx + b$ for slope 3, y-intercept −5. _____ *(Answer: $y = 3x - 5$)*

7. Graphing

Online: Plot points, lines, or bars on a grid. **On paper:** Use the printed coordinate grid and a pencil.

Example (Math). On the grid provided, plot (−2, 4) and draw the line $y = x + 1$.

8. Hot Text

Online: Click a sentence or phrase in the passage. **On paper:** Underline, or write the number of, the sentence that answers the question.

Example (Reading). Underline the sentence that **best** supports the idea that the narrator felt nervous.

9. Written Responses (SCR and ECR)

Online: Type in a text box. **On paper:** Write in the lined space provided.

- **Short Constructed Response (SCR)** — a few sentences with text evidence (2 points).
- **Extended Constructed Response (ECR)** — a full multi-paragraph essay (10 points).

You will practice these in depth in the **SCR Mastery** and **ECR Mastery** sections.

> **Strategy:** When a question says "Select TWO" or "least to greatest," underline those words before you answer. Many points are lost not from wrong math or reading, but from missing the directions.

Your Study Calendars

Pick the plan that fits the time you have. Each uses the same four stages — **Learn, Practice, Simulate, Diagnose** — and spreads the eight full-length tests so you never cram. Check off each day as you go.

> **Key Idea:** Short, steady sessions beat one long rush. Aim for 30–45 focused minutes per study day.

The 4-Week Sprint (test is coming soon)

Week	Focus	Do This
1	Math — Strands 1 & 2	Read lessons; warm-up drills; take **Math Test 1**; review every explanation
2	Math — Strands 3 & 4	Lessons; drills; take **Math Tests 2 & 3**; fill diagnostic charts; redo weak skills
3	RLA — Reading + SCR	Genre guide & reading lessons; **SCR Mastery**; take **RLA Tests 1 & 2**
4	RLA — Writing + ECR, then finish	Revising/editing refresher; **ECR Mastery**; take **Math Test 4**, **RLA Tests 3 & 4**; final review

The 8-Week Plan (more time, deeper mastery)

Week	Focus	Do This
1	Math Strand 1 — Numerical	Lesson + drills; begin a daily routine
2	Math Strand 2 — Computations & Algebraic	Lesson + drills; **Math Test 1** + review
3	Math Strand 3 — Geometry & Measurement	Lesson + drills; **Math Test 2** + diagnostic chart
4	Math Strand 4 — Data & Financial Literacy	Lesson + drills; **Math Test 3**; reteach weak skills
5	RLA Reading — genres & strategies	Genre guide + reading lessons; hot-text practice

6	RLA Short Constructed Response	**SCR Mastery**; **RLA Test 1** + review
7	RLA Revising & Editing	Conventions refresher; **RLA Test 2**; **Math Test 4**
8	RLA Extended Constructed Response + final push	**ECR Mastery**; **RLA Tests 3 & 4**; final diagnostic review

Watch Out: Do not skip the review step. The biggest score gains come from understanding **why** you missed a question, then practicing that exact skill again.

Test-Day Game Plan

You have practiced the skills and the question types. Test day is simply one more practice test — this time for real. Follow this plan to stay calm and finish strong.

The Night Before

- Pack what you need and go to bed on time. Rest helps your brain more than last-minute cramming.
- Do a light review of your **diagnostic charts** only — no new material.

The Morning Of

- Eat a good breakfast. Arrive early so you feel settled, not rushed.
- Take a few slow breaths before you begin. You are ready.

During the Test — Your Pacing Plan

1. **Read the directions of each question carefully.** Watch for *select two*, *least to greatest*, and *best*.
2. **Answer the questions you know first.** Flag harder ones and return — don't let one question eat your time.
3. **Use your tools.** On Math, use the **calculator** and **reference sheet** and show work on scratch paper. On Reading, use the online **dictionary** when a word blocks understanding.
4. **Eliminate wrong answers.** Crossing out two choices doubles your odds on a tricky question.
5. **Never leave a question blank.** There is no penalty for guessing. Make your best choice and flag it to revisit.

Budgeting Time for Written Responses (RLA)

- Keep **SCR** answers short and direct — make your point, give **text evidence**, done.
- Save time for the **ECR** essay (10 points). A quick plan — thesis, two or three supporting points with evidence, a conclusion — keeps you organized. A partial, organized essay still earns points; a blank one earns none.

Before You Submit

- Return to every flagged question; make sure each has an answer.

- Check that multiselect questions have the **right number** of choices marked.
- Reread written responses once for clear sentences, correct spelling, and punctuation.

Key Idea: Finish every question with *some* answer, give the written responses real effort, and use your full time. Steady and complete beats fast and blank.

You've got this. Now turn the page and start building your skills.

Part 1 · Mathematics

How Grade 8 Math Is Built

The Grade 8 Mathematics test has **40 questions worth 48 points.** Every question is drawn from one of **four strands** (the state calls them reporting categories). Knowing the strands tells you exactly what to study — and this book teaches **every skill in every strand.**

Strand	What It Covers	On the Test
1 · Numerical Representations & Relationships	Real numbers, irrational numbers, scientific notation, ordering numbers	~4 questions
2 · Computations & Algebraic Relationships	Slope, linear equations, functions, one-variable equations	~15 questions (largest)
3 · Geometry & Measurement	Dilations, transformations, volume, surface area, Pythagorean theorem, angles	~13 questions
4 · Data Analysis & Personal Financial Literacy	Scatterplots, trend lines, mean absolute deviation, interest, saving	~8 questions

Readiness vs. Supporting Standards

- ★ **Readiness standard** — tested heavily every year; carries most of the points. Master these first.
- ○ **Supporting standard** — tested less often, but still fair game.

The Process Standards (8.1 A–G)

STAAR also weaves in **mathematical process standards**: applying math to real situations, choosing a strategy, using tools, and explaining your reasoning. You practice these inside every lesson and test — they are *how* you do the math, not a separate topic.

> **Key Idea:** Read each lesson, do the warm-up drills, then prove it on the practice tests. Use the **reference sheet** on the next page the whole way through — it is yours on the real test, too.

Grade 8 Mathematics Reference Sheet

On the real STAAR test, these formulas are provided for you. Learn where each one is so you can find it fast. (This replicates the key formulas from the STAAR Grade 8 Mathematics Reference Materials.)

Perimeter & Circumference	**Area**
Circle: $\mathbf{C = 2\pi r}$ or $\mathbf{C = \pi d}$	Triangle: $\mathbf{A = \frac{1}{2}bh}$ Rectangle / Parallelogram: $\mathbf{A = bh}$ Trapezoid: $\mathbf{A = \frac{1}{2}(b_1 + b_2)h}$ Circle: $\mathbf{A = \pi r^2}$
Surface Area (B = base area, P = base perimeter)	**Volume** (B = base area)
Prism — Lateral: $\mathbf{S = Ph}$ · Total: $\mathbf{S = Ph + 2B}$ Cylinder — Lateral: $\mathbf{S = 2\pi rh}$ · Total: $\mathbf{S = 2\pi rh + 2\pi r^2}$	Prism / Cylinder: $\mathbf{V = Bh}$ Cone: $\mathbf{V = \frac{1}{3}Bh}$ Sphere: $\mathbf{V = \frac{4}{3}\pi r^3}$
Algebra & Graphing	**Personal Financial Literacy**
Slope: $\mathbf{m = (y_2 - y_1) / (x_2 - x_1)}$ Slope-intercept form: $\mathbf{y = mx + b}$ Direct variation: $\mathbf{y = kx}$ Pythagorean theorem: $\mathbf{a^2 + b^2 = c^2}$	Simple interest: $\mathbf{I = Prt}$ Compound interest: $\mathbf{A = P(1 + r/n)^{nt}}$
Useful Constants & Conversions	
$\mathbf{\pi \approx 3.14}$ (or $22/7$) · Metric: 1 m = 100 cm = 1000 mm; 1 km = 1000 m · Customary: 1 ft = 12 in; 1 yd = 3 ft; 1 mi = 5,280 ft	

Strategy: You do **not** need to memorize these — but you must know they exist and how to use them. Every worked example that uses a formula shows you which one and why.

Strand 1 · Numerical Representations and Relationships

What this strand tests: how to represent, compare, and order real numbers — including irrational numbers and scientific notation.

Standards covered:

- ○ **8.2A** — Describe relationships between sets of real numbers using a visual representation.
- ○ **8.2B** — Approximate an irrational number (including π and square roots of numbers less than 225) and locate it on a number line.
- ○ **8.2C** — Convert between standard decimal notation and scientific notation.
- ★ **8.2D** — Order a set of real numbers from mathematical and real-world contexts. *(Readiness)*

8.2A · The Real Number System ○

Every number you use at Grade 8 is a **real number.** Real numbers divide into groups nested inside one another:

- **Natural:** 1, 2, 3, … **Whole:** 0, 1, 2, 3, … **Integers:** … −2, −1, 0, 1, 2, …
- **Rational:** any number written as a fraction a/b — integers, terminating decimals (0.75), repeating decimals (0.333…).
- **Irrational:** cannot be written as a simple fraction; decimals never end or repeat — such as **π** and **√2**.

> **Key Idea:** The groups are *nested* — every natural number is also whole, an integer, and rational. But rational and irrational never overlap.

Worked example. Classify √16 and √20. √16 = 4 → natural, whole, integer, **rational.** √20 ≈ 4.472… → **irrational.**

Watch Out: A square root is irrational only when the number is **not** a perfect square. √25 = 5 is rational; √26 is irrational.

Try It. Every integer is a rational number — true or false? *(True: any integer n = n/1.)*

8.2B · Approximating Irrational Numbers ○

To estimate a square root, find the two **perfect squares** it falls between.

Worked example. Approximate √50. $49 = 7^2$ and $64 = 8^2$, so √50 is between **7 and 8**; just above 49, so √50 ≈ **7.1** — mark it just right of 7 on a number line. **π ≈ 3.14**, between 3 and 4.

Watch Out: "Less than 225" means the number under the root is below 225 — roots up to about √224 ≈ 14.97.

Try It. Between which two whole numbers is √30? *(5 and 6, since 25 < 30 < 36.)*

8.2C · Scientific Notation ○

Scientific notation writes a number as $\mathbf{a \times 10^n}$, where $\mathbf{1 \le |a| < 10}$ and n is an integer. Large numbers → positive exponent; small numbers (less than 1) → negative exponent.

- 4,500,000 = $\mathbf{4.5 \times 10^6}$ · 0.00032 = $\mathbf{3.2 \times 10^{-4}}$ · 7.1×10^5 = **710,000**

Watch Out: The factor *a* must be at least 1 and less than 10. Writing 45×10^5 is wrong — fix to 4.5×10^6.

Try It. Write 0.0067 in scientific notation. *(6.7×10^{-3}.)*

8.2D · Ordering Real Numbers ★ (Readiness)

Numbers often appear in different forms at once — fractions, decimals, percents, roots, scientific notation. **Convert them all to decimals, then compare.**

Worked example. Order from least to greatest: ⅗, 0.58, √0.36, 62%.
⅗ = 0.60 · 0.58 = 0.58 · √0.36 = 0.60 · 62% = 0.62 → **0.58, then ⅗ = √0.36, then 62%.**

> **Key Idea:** One common form — usually the decimal — lets you compare very different-looking numbers fairly. A number line helps you *see* the order.

Watch Out: On a negative number line, the number farther **left** is **smaller**. −0.8 < −0.3.

Try It. Order greatest to least: 0.7, ⅔, 71%. *(71% = 0.71, 0.7, ⅔ ≈ 0.667.)*

Strand 1 Checklist

- ☐ 8.2A Classify real numbers and describe how the sets relate
- ☐ 8.2B Approximate irrational numbers and place them on a number line
- ☐ 8.2C Convert between standard and scientific notation
- ☐ 8.2D Order a mixed set of real numbers

Ready to practice? Warm-up drills for Strand 1 come after all four strand lessons.

Strand 2 · Computations and Algebraic Relationships

This is the **largest strand** on the test (about 15 of 40 questions). It is all about **lines, relationships, and equations.** Master it and you master most of the Math test.

Standards covered:

- ○ **8.4A** — Similar right triangles show slope is the same between any two points on a line.
- ★ **8.4B** — Graph proportional relationships; interpret the unit rate as the slope.
- ★ **8.4C** — Use a table or graph to find the rate of change (slope) and the y-intercept.
- ○ **8.5A** — Linear proportional situations as y = kx. ○ **8.5B** — Non-proportional as y = mx + b (b ≠ 0).
- ○ **8.5E** — Direct variation. ○ **8.5F** — Distinguish proportional from non-proportional. ○ **8.5H** — Examples of each.
- ★ **8.5G** — Identify functions from ordered pairs, tables, mappings, graphs.
- ★ **8.5I** — Write an equation y = mx + b to model a linear relationship.
- ○ **8.8A** — Write one-variable equations/inequalities with variables on both sides. ○ **8.8B** — Write a real-world problem for a given equation. ★ **8.8C** — Model and solve them.
- ○ **8.9A** — Identify a system's solution from the intersection of two graphs.

Part A · Slope and Rate of Change (8.4A ○, 8.4B ★, 8.4C ★)

Slope measures how steep a line is — how much *y* changes for each change in *x*:

$$\textbf{slope} = m = (\text{change in } y) \div (\text{change in } x) = (y_2 - y_1) / (x_2 - x_1)$$

- **8.4A — Why slope is constant.** Right triangles drawn to any two points on the same line are **similar**, so rise ÷ run is the **same everywhere** — that ratio is the slope.
- **8.4B — Proportional graphs.** A proportional relationship passes through the **origin (0, 0)**; equation **y = kx**; the **unit rate is the slope k.**
- **8.4C — From a table or graph.** Slope = (change in y) ÷ (change in x); the **y-intercept** is the y-value when **x = 0.**

Worked example (8.4C). Table: (0, 2), (1, 5), (2, 8). Slope = (5 − 2) ÷ (1 − 0) = **3**; y-intercept = **2**; equation y = 3x + 2.

Watch Out: Rise over run — count the **vertical** change first, then horizontal.

Try It. A line through (0, 0) and (4, 10) — slope? *(10 ÷ 4 = 2.5.)*

Part B · Proportional vs. Non-Proportional (8.5A/B/E/F/H ○)

	Proportional	Non-Proportional

Equation	y = kx	y = mx + b (b ≠ 0)
Graph	Line **through the origin**	Line **not** through the origin
Table	Constant ratio $y/x = k$	y/x is **not** constant

- **8.5E — Direct variation** is a proportional relationship y = kx. If y = 15 when x = 3, then k = 5, so y = 5x.
- **8.5F / 8.5H — Telling them apart.** Does the line pass through (0, 0)? Yes → proportional. A starting amount (y-intercept ≠ 0) → non-proportional.

Worked example (8.5B). A gym charges a $20 sign-up fee plus $5 per visit: **y = 5x + 20.** The $20 fee (b ≠ 0) makes it **non-proportional.**

Watch Out: A per-item rate with no starting fee is proportional; add any flat fee and it becomes non-proportional.

Try It. Is y = 7x proportional? *(Yes — passes through the origin, b = 0.)*

Part C · Functions (8.5G ★)

A **function** pairs **each input (x) with exactly one output (y).** In tables/mappings, an x-value may not repeat with two different y-values. On graphs, use the **vertical line test** — if any vertical line crosses the graph more than once, it is **not** a function.

Worked example. Is {(1, 3), (2, 5), (1, 7)} a function? **No** — input 1 pairs with both 3 and 7.

Try It. Does a non-vertical straight line pass the vertical line test? *(Yes — it is a function.)*

Part D · Writing Linear Equations (8.5I ★)

To write **y = mx + b**, find the **slope m** and the **y-intercept b.**

Worked example. A plant is 4 cm tall and grows 2 cm each week. Slope m = **2**; y-intercept b = **4**; equation **y = 2x + 4.**

Strategy: "Starting amount" is almost always **b**; "rate per unit" is almost always **m.**

Try It. A taxi charges $3 to start plus $2 per mile. Equation for cost y after x miles? *(y = 2x + 3.)*

Part E · One-Variable Equations and Inequalities (8.8A/B ○, 8.8C ★)

When the variable is on **both sides,** collect variable terms on one side and numbers on the other.

Worked example (8.8C). Solve 3x + 5 = x − 7. Subtract x → 2x + 5 = −7 Subtract 5 → 2x = −12 Divide by 2 → **x = −6.**

8.8A write such equations from a situation; **8.8B** do the reverse — describe a real situation the equation could model.

Watch Out: Whatever you do to one side, do to the **other** side — keep it balanced.

Try It. Solve 4x − 3 = 2x + 9. *(2x = 12, x = 6.)*

Part F · Systems of Two Linear Equations (8.9A ○)

Two lines graphed together **intersect** at the point that **satisfies both equations.** That point **(x, y)** is the **solution** of the system.

Worked example. y = x + 1 and y = −x + 5 cross at **(2, 3).** Check: 3 = 2 + 1 ✓ and 3 = −2 + 5 ✓.

Try It. If two lines cross at (−1, 4), what is the solution? *(x = −1, y = 4.)*

Strand 2 Checklist

- ☐ 8.4A–C Find and interpret slope, unit rate, and y-intercept
- ☐ 8.5A/B/E/F/H Tell proportional from non-proportional; use y = kx and y = mx + b
- ☐ 8.5G Identify functions (including the vertical line test)
- ☐ 8.5I Write an equation for a linear relationship
- ☐ 8.8A–C Write and solve one-variable equations with variables on both sides
- ☐ 8.9A Identify a system's solution from the intersection of two graphs

Strand 3 · Geometry and Measurement

This strand (about 13 of 40 questions) covers **dilations, transformations, angles, volume, surface area, and the Pythagorean theorem.** Keep the **reference sheet** open — most of these use a formula.

Standards covered:

- ○ **8.3A** — Ratio of corresponding sides of similar shapes is proportional. ○ **8.3B** — Compare a shape and its dilation on a plane. ★ **8.3C** — Algebraic rule for a scale factor (origin center).
- ○ **8.6A** — Volume formula V = Bh of a cylinder. ○ **8.6C** — Explain the Pythagorean theorem with models.
- ★ **8.7A** — Volume of cylinders, cones, spheres. ★ **8.7B** — Surface area of prisms and cylinders. ★ **8.7C** — Pythagorean theorem and its converse. ○ **8.7D** — Distance between two points.
- ○ **8.8D** — Angle sums, exterior angles, transversal angles, AA similarity.
- ○ **8.10A** — Orientation/congruence of transformations. ○ **8.10B** — Which preserve congruence. ★ **8.10C** — Rules for translations, reflections, rotations (90/180/270/360). ○ **8.10D** — Effect of a dilation on length and area.

Part A · Dilations and Similarity (8.3A ○, 8.3B ○, 8.3C ★, 8.10D ○)

A **dilation** resizes a figure by a **scale factor k** from a center. With the **origin** as center: **(x, y) → (kx, ky).**

- **8.3A / 8.3B — Similar shapes.** A figure and its dilation are **similar**: corresponding sides are proportional (×k) and angles stay the **same.**
- **8.10D — Effect on measurements.** Lengths multiply by **k**; **area** multiplies by $\mathbf{k^2}$**.**

Worked example (8.3C). Vertex (2, 3) dilated by factor 3 about the origin → (3·2, 3·3) = **(6, 9).**

Watch Out: k > 1 enlarges; 0 < k < 1 shrinks. Area changes by the **square** of k — factor 2 makes area **4×**.

Try It. A square of side 5 is dilated by k = 2 — new side? *(10.)*

Part B · Transformations on the Coordinate Plane (8.10A/B ○, 8.10C ★)

Transformation	Algebraic rule	Changes size?
Translation (slide)	(x, y) → (x + a, y + b)	No — congruent
Reflection over x-axis	(x, y) → (x, −y)	No — congruent
Reflection over y-axis	(x, y) → (−x, y)	No — congruent
Rotation 180° about origin	(x, y) → (−x, −y)	No — congruent
Rotation 90° counterclockwise	(x, y) → (−y, x)	No — congruent

Dilation (factor k)	(x, y) → (kx, ky)	**Yes** — similar, not congruent

8.10A / 8.10B — Congruence. Translations, reflections, and rotations are **rigid** — the image is **congruent.** A dilation (k ≠ 1) changes size, so it is **not** congruent, only **similar.**

Worked example (8.10C). Reflect (4, −2) over the x-axis → **(4, 2).**

Watch Out: Reflecting over the **x-axis** flips the **y**-sign; over the **y-axis** flips the **x**-sign.

Try It. Rotate (3, 5) by 180° about the origin. *((−3, −5).)*

Part C · Angle Relationships (8.8D ○)

- **Triangle angle sum:** interior angles add to **180°.**
- **Exterior angle** = sum of the two remote interior angles.
- **Parallel lines + transversal:** corresponding angles equal; alternate interior angles equal.
- **Angle-Angle (AA) similarity:** two equal angles → triangles are **similar.**

Worked example. Angles 50° and 60° → third = 180 − 50 − 60 = **70°.**

Try It. Angles 90° and 35° — find the third. *(55°.)*

Part D · Volume (8.6A ○, 8.7A ★)

- **Cylinder:** V = Bh = $\pi r^2 h$. **Cone:** V = $\frac{1}{3}\pi r^2 h$ (one-third of the cylinder). **Sphere:** V = $\frac{4}{3}\pi r^3$.

Worked example (8.7A). Cylinder radius 3, height 10: V = $\pi(3^2)(10)$ = **$90\pi \approx 282.6$** cubic units.

Watch Out: The cone is ⅓ of the matching cylinder — don't forget the one-third.

Try It. Cone radius 3, height 10 — volume? *(⅓·90π = 30π ≈ 94.2.)*

Part E · Surface Area (8.7B ★)

- **Prism — total:** S = Ph + 2B. **Cylinder — total:** S = $2\pi rh + 2\pi r^2$ (side plus two circles).

Worked example (8.7B). Cylinder radius 2, height 5: S = $2\pi(2)(5) + 2\pi(2^2) = 20\pi + 8\pi$ = **$28\pi \approx 87.9$** square units.

Strategy: "Lateral" = the **side** only; "total" **adds the bases.** Read which one is asked.

Try It. Lateral surface area of that cylinder? *($2\pi rh = 20\pi \approx 62.8$.)*

Part F · The Pythagorean Theorem (8.6C ○, 8.7C ★, 8.7D ○)

For a **right triangle** with legs a and b and hypotenuse c: $\mathbf{a^2 + b^2 = c^2}$.

- **8.7C** — Find a missing side, or use the **converse** to test whether a triangle is right.

- **8.7D** — Distance between two points: horizontal and vertical gaps are the legs; the distance is the hypotenuse.

Worked example (8.7C). Legs 6 and 8: $c^2 = 36 + 64 = 100 \rightarrow c =$ **10.** **(8.7D)** Distance (1, 2) to (4, 6): legs 3 and 4 $\rightarrow \sqrt{(9 + 16)} =$ **5.**

Watch Out: The hypotenuse **c** is across from the right angle and is the **longest** side.

Try It. Is 5, 12, 13 a right triangle? *(Yes — 25 + 144 = 169 = 13^2.)*

Strand 3 Checklist

- ☐ 8.3A–C, 8.10D Dilate figures; use scale factor; length ×k and area ×k^2
- ☐ 8.10A–C Apply translation, reflection, rotation rules; know what stays congruent
- ☐ 8.8D Use angle sums, exterior angles, transversals, AA similarity
- ☐ 8.6A, 8.7A Volume of cylinders, cones, spheres
- ☐ 8.7B Lateral and total surface area of prisms and cylinders
- ☐ 8.6C, 8.7C, 8.7D Pythagorean theorem, converse, and distance

Strand 4 · Data Analysis and Personal Financial Literacy

This strand (about 8 of 40 questions) has two halves: **reading data** (scatterplots, trend lines, spread) and **personal finance** (interest, saving, the cost of borrowing).

Standards covered:

- ○ **8.5C** — Contrast bivariate data that suggest a linear relationship with data that do not. ★ **8.5D** — Use a trend line to make predictions.
- ○ **8.11A** — Construct a scatterplot and describe the association. ○ **8.11B** — Mean absolute deviation (≤10 points).
- ○ **8.12A** — How rate and loan length affect the cost of credit. ○ **8.12C** — How regular saving grows. ★ **8.12D** — Simple vs. compound interest. ○ **8.12G** — Estimate college cost and a savings plan.

Part A · Scatterplots and Association (8.5C ○, 8.11A ○)

A **scatterplot** graphs paired (bivariate) data. The pattern shows the **association**: **positive linear** (points rise), **negative linear** (points fall), **non-linear** (a curve), or **no association** (scattered).

Worked example. Study time up, scores up → points rise right → **positive linear.** **Try It.** TV hours up, grades down → *negative linear.*

Part B · Trend Lines and Predictions (8.5D ★)

A **trend line** (line of best fit) runs through the middle of the data; use it to **predict** values you did not measure.

Worked example. Trend line y = 2x + 3 (x = weeks). Height at week 10: y = 2(10) + 3 = **23 cm.** **Watch Out:** a prediction is an **estimate**, not exact.

Part C · Mean Absolute Deviation (MAD) (8.11B ○)

MAD = the **average distance of each value from the mean.** Steps: (1) find the mean, (2) find each distance from the mean, (3) average those distances.

Worked example. Data 2, 4, 6, 8. Mean = 5. Distances 3, 1, 1, 3. MAD = 8 ÷ 4 = **2.** **Try It.** MAD of 10, 10, 20, 20? *(Mean 15; MAD = 5.)*

Part D · Personal Financial Literacy (8.12A/C/G ○, 8.12D ★)

Simple interest: $I = Prt$. **Compound interest:** $A = P(1 + r/n)^{nt}$ — interest earns interest, so it grows faster.

Worked example (8.12D). $500 at 4% for 3 years, **simple**: $I = 500 \times 0.04 \times 3 =$ **$60.** Compound would earn slightly more.

- **8.12A — Cost of credit.** A higher rate or a longer loan means you pay **more** interest overall.
- **8.12C — Saving regularly.** Small, steady amounts add up and grow — especially with compound interest and time.
- **8.12G — College savings.** Estimate total cost, subtract expected family contribution, divide the rest across the months you have.

Try It. Simple interest on $1,000 at 5% for 2 years? *(1000 × 0.05 × 2 = $100.)*

Strand 4 Checklist

- ☐ 8.5C, 8.11A Read scatterplots and name the association
- ☐ 8.5D Use a trend line to predict · ☐ 8.11B Calculate mean absolute deviation
- ☐ 8.12A/C/D/G Simple vs. compound interest, cost of credit, saving and college planning

Process Standards in Action (8.1 A–G)

The **mathematical process standards** are not a separate topic — they are *how* you do every problem. STAAR builds them into questions across all four strands.

Standard	What it asks you to do	How you use it
8.1A	Apply math to everyday life, society, work	Solve real-world problems (cost, distance, savings)
8.1B	Use a problem-solving model	Analyze, plan, solve, check reasonableness
8.1C	Choose the right tools and techniques	Calculator, mental math, estimation, reference sheet
8.1D	Communicate with multiple representations	Move between symbols, tables, graphs, words
8.1E	Create and use representations	Draw a diagram, make a table, sketch a graph
8.1F	Analyze relationships to connect ideas	See slope, tables, equations as the same line
8.1G	Justify reasoning with precise language	Explain *why* an answer is correct

Key Idea: Strong test-takers do more than "get the answer." They **check that it makes sense,** choose efficient tools, and can explain their thinking. Practice that on every item.

Strategy: After each answer ask: *Does this make sense?* A volume should be positive, a probability between 0 and 1, a slope matching the line's direction. Catching an unreasonable answer saves easy points.

Warm-Up Skill Drills

Short, mixed drills to warm up before the full-length tests. Do a set, then check the answer key. Each item names the TEKS it practices.

Strand 1 — Numerical Representations and Relationships

1. **(8.2D)** Order from least to greatest: 0.45, ⅖, √0.2, 43%.
2. **(8.2B)** Between which two whole numbers is √72?
3. **(8.2C)** Write 0.00056 in scientific notation.
4. **(8.2A)** Is √81 rational or irrational?
5. **(8.2C)** Write 3.2×10^5 in standard form.

Strand 2 — Computations and Algebraic Relationships

6. **(8.4C)** Find the slope of the line through (2, 3) and (6, 11).
7. **(8.5I)** A tank holds 50 L and drains 4 L per minute. Write an equation for amount y after x minutes.
8. **(8.5G)** Is {(2, 4), (3, 9), (2, 5)} a function?
9. **(8.8C)** Solve $5x - 2 = 3x + 8$.
10. **(8.5F)** Is $y = 6x$ proportional or non-proportional?

Strand 3 — Geometry and Measurement

11. **(8.7C)** A right triangle has legs 9 and 12. Find the hypotenuse.
12. **(8.7A)** Volume of a cylinder with radius 5, height 4 ($\pi \approx 3.14$).
13. **(8.10C)** Reflect (−3, 7) over the y-axis.
14. **(8.3C)** Dilate (4, −6) by scale factor ½ about the origin.
15. **(8.8D)** Two angles of a triangle are 42° and 73°. Find the third.

Strand 4 — Data Analysis and Personal Financial Literacy

16. **(8.12D)** Simple interest on $500 at 4% for 3 years.
17. **(8.11B)** Mean absolute deviation of 2, 4, 6, 8.
18. **(8.5D)** Trend line $y = 2x + 3$. Predict y when x = 10.
19. **(8.11A)** Points rise from lower-left to upper-right — name the association.
20. **(8.12A)** True or false: a longer loan at the same rate usually costs more in total interest.

Answer Key — Warm-Up Drills

1. ⅖ (0.40), 43% (0.43), √0.2 (≈0.447), 0.45 · 2. 8 and 9 · 3. 5.6×10^{-4} · 4. Rational (= 9) · 5. 320,000 · 6. m = 2 · 7. y = −4x + 50 · 8. No (input 2 → two outputs) · 9. x = 5 · 10. Proportional · 11. c = 15 · 12. 314 cubic units · 13. (3, 7) · 14. (2, −3) · 15. 65° · 16. $60 · 17. 2 · 18. 23 · 19. Positive linear · 20. True

Mathematics · Practice Test 1

40 questions · Calculator allowed · Use the Grade 8 Mathematics Reference Sheet

Read each question carefully. Watch for directions like *Select TWO* and *least to greatest*.

Reporting Category 1 · Numerical Representations and Relationships

1. Which list is ordered from **least to greatest**?

A. ⅔, 68%, 0.7, √0.5 B. √0.5, 0.7, 68%, ⅔ C. 68%, ⅔, √0.5, 0.7 D. 0.7, √0.5, ⅔, 68%

2. Between which two whole numbers does √40 lie?

A. 5 and 6 B. 6 and 7 C. 19 and 21 D. 20 and 21

3. *(Griddable)* Write 68,000 in scientific notation. ☐

4. Which number is **irrational**? A. √36 B. ⅘ C. π D. 0.25

Reporting Category 2 · Computations and Algebraic Relationships

5. What is the slope of the line through (1, 2) and (4, 11)? A. 2 B. 3 C. 6 D. 9

6. A proportional relationship passes through the origin and the point (3, 12). What is the unit rate? A. 3 B. 4 C. 9 D. 15

7. Why is the slope of a straight line the same between any two points?

A. The line is horizontal B. The right triangles formed are **similar**, so rise÷run is constant C. All lines have slope 1 D. The points are always 1 unit apart

8. *(Equation editor)* A plant is 6 cm tall and grows 3 cm per week. Write an equation for its height y after x weeks. ☐

9. Which set of ordered pairs represents a **function**?

A. {(1, 2), (1, 3), (2, 4)} B. {(2, 5), (3, 5), (4, 5)} C. {(0, 1), (0, 2), (0, 3)} D. {(5, 1), (5, 2), (6, 3)}

10. Which equation represents a **proportional** relationship? A. $y = 4x$ B. $y = 4x + 2$ C. $y = x - 4$ D. $y = 2x - 1$

11. A gym charges a $15 membership fee plus $6 per visit. Which equation gives the cost y for x visits? A. $y = 15x + 6$ B. $y = 6x + 15$ C. $y = 21x$ D. $y = 6x - 15$

12. *(Griddable)* For a direct variation, $y = 20$ when $x = 5$. What is y when $x = 9$? ☐

13. Which table shows a **non-proportional** relationship?

A. (1, 3)(2, 6)(3, 9) B. (1, 5)(2, 10)(3, 15) C. (1, 4)(2, 7)(3, 10) D. (2, 8)(3, 12)(4, 16)

14. Which situation is **proportional**?

A. A taxi charges $3 plus $2 per mile B. A pool has 10 L and drains 2 L per minute C. Apples cost $2 per pound D. A phone plan is $20 plus $0.10 per text

15. *(Griddable)* Solve for x: $6x + 4 = 2x + 20$. ☐

16. "Three less than twice a number equals the number plus five." Which equation models this? A. $2x - 3 = x + 5$ B. $3 - 2x = x + 5$ C. $2x + 3 = x - 5$ D. $3x - 2 = x + 5$

17. Which situation can be modeled by $5x + 10 = 3x + 30$?

A. Two savers start with $10 and $30 and save $5 and $3 per week; when are the totals equal? B. A number times 5 C. The area of a rectangle D. The sum of 10 and 30

18. Two lines are graphed and cross at (2, 5). What is the solution of the system? A. $x = 5, y = 2$ B. $x = 2, y = 5$ C. $x = 7$ D. No solution

19. *(Select TWO)* Which statements about the line $y = 2x - 3$ are true? A. The slope is 2 B. The slope is −3 C. The y-intercept is −3 D. It passes through the origin

Reporting Category 3 · Geometry and Measurement

20. A cylinder has radius 4 and height 7. What is its volume? ($\pi \approx 3.14$) A. 87.92 B. 175.84 C. 351.68 D. 703.36

21. A cone has radius 6 and height 10. What is its volume? ($\pi \approx 3.14$) A. 125.6 B. 376.8 C. 1130.4 D. 3768

22. A cylinder has radius 3 and height 8. What is its **total** surface area? ($\pi \approx 3.14$) A. 150.72 B. 169.56 C. 207.24 D. 263.76

23. *(Griddable)* A right triangle has legs of 7 and 24. What is the length of the hypotenuse? ☐

24. What is the distance between (−1, −3) and (3, 0)? A. 5 B. 7 C. 12 D. 25

25. The point (−2, 5) is dilated by a scale factor of 3 about the origin. What is the image? A. (−6, 15) B. (6, 15) C. (−5, 8) D. (1, 8)

26. The point (5, −4) is reflected over the y-axis. What is the image? A. (5, 4) B. (−5, −4) C. (−5, 4) D. (4, −5)

27. The point (2, 7) is rotated 90° counterclockwise about the origin. What is the image? A. (7, 2) B. (−7, 2) C. (7, −2) D. (−2, −7)

28. Which transformation does **not** preserve congruence? A. Translation B. Reflection C. Rotation D. Dilation (scale factor 3)

29. The angles of a triangle measure 3x, 2x, and x. What is the measure of the largest angle? A. 30° B. 60° C. 90° D. 120°

30. Two similar rectangles have corresponding sides in a ratio of 2 : 5. The smaller has a length of 6. What is the matching length of the larger? A. 10 B. 12 C. 15 D. 18

31. In the cylinder volume formula $V = Bh$, what does B represent? A. $2\pi r$ B. πr^2 C. πd D. $r + h$

32. A square with side 4 is dilated by a scale factor of 3. What is the area of the image? A. 12 B. 48 C. 108 D. 144

Reporting Category 4 · Data Analysis and Personal Financial Literacy

33. *(Griddable)* Find the mean absolute deviation of 3, 5, 7, 9. ☐

34. A trend line is modeled by y = 1.5x + 2. Predict *y* when x = 8. A. 11 B. 12 C. 14 D. 16

35. On a scatterplot, the points fall from the upper-left to the lower-right. What association is shown? A. Positive linear B. Negative linear C. No association D. Non-linear

36. Which description suggests a **linear** association between two variables? A. Points scattered randomly B. Points following a straight upward path C. Points forming a U-shape D. Points in a circle

37. *(Griddable)* Find the simple interest on $800 at 5% for 4 years. ☐

38. For the same loan amount and interest rate, which loan costs the **most** total interest? A. A 2-year loan B. A 3-year loan C. A 5-year loan D. They cost the same

39. How do small amounts of money invested regularly behave over time? A. They lose value B. They stay exactly the same C. They grow, especially with compound interest D. They cannot be saved

40. College costs $12,000. A family expects to contribute $4,000 and wants to save the rest over 16 months. How much must they save each month? A. $250 B. $500 C. $750 D. $1,000

Answers and full explanations for this test are in Part 3 · Answer Keys & Explanations.

Mathematics · Practice Test 2

40 questions · Calculator allowed · Use the Grade 8 Mathematics Reference Sheet

Read each question carefully. Watch for directions like *Select TWO* and *least to greatest*.

Reporting Category 1 · Numerical Representations and Relationships

1. Which list is ordered from **least to greatest**?

A. 0.72, ¾, √0.6, 78% B. ¾, 0.72, 78%, √0.6 C. 78%, √0.6, ¾, 0.72 D. √0.6, 0.72, ¾, 78%

2. Between which two whole numbers does √90 lie? A. 8 and 9 B. 9 and 10 C. 44 and 46 D. 89 and 91

3. *(Griddable)* Write 0.00045 in scientific notation. ☐

4. Which number is **rational**? A. √8 B. √16 C. π D. √2

Reporting Category 2 · Computations and Algebraic Relationships

5. What is the slope of the line through (−2, 1) and (2, 9)? A. 1 B. 2 C. 4 D. 8

6. A proportional relationship passes through the origin and the point (5, 15). What is the unit rate? A. 3 B. 5 C. 10 D. 15

7. *(Equation editor)* A candle is 20 cm tall and burns down 2 cm each hour. Write an equation for its height y after x hours. ☐

8. Which relation is a **function**?

A. {(2, 1), (2, 3), (4, 5)} B. {(1, 6), (2, 6), (3, 7)} C. {(5, 2), (5, 4), (6, 8)} D. {(0, 0), (0, 1), (1, 2)}

9. Which equation represents a **non-proportional** relationship? A. y = 3x B. y = 7x C. y = 3x + 4 D. y = ½x

10. *(Griddable)* For a direct variation, y = 36 when x = 4. What is y when x = 7? ☐

11. Which table shows a **proportional** relationship?

A. (1, 2)(2, 5)(3, 8) B. (1, 4)(2, 8)(3, 12) C. (1, 3)(2, 5)(3, 7) D. (2, 7)(3, 9)(4, 11)

12. *(Griddable)* Solve for x: 7x − 5 = 3x + 19. ☐

13. "Five more than three times a number equals twice the number plus twelve." Which equation models this? A. 3x + 5 = 2x + 12 B. 5x + 3 = 12x + 2 C. 3x − 5 = 2x + 12 D. 5 + 3 = 2x + 12

14. Two lines intersect at (−3, 2). What is the solution of the system? A. x = 2, y = −3 B. x = −3, y = 2 C. x = −1 D. No solution

15. On a line, right triangles are drawn to two different pairs of points. What must be true of the triangles? A. Congruent B. **Similar**, so the slope is the same C. Equal area D. Isosceles

16. Which situation represents a **proportional** relationship?

A. A plumber charges $50 plus $40 per hour B. A runner travels 6 miles per hour at a steady pace C. A tank has 30 L and loses 5 L per hour D. A gym costs $25 to join plus $5 per class

17. Which situation can be modeled by $4x + 6 = 2x + 18$?

A. Two accounts start at $6 and $18 and grow $4 and $2 per week; when are they equal? B. The product of 4 and 6 C. A rectangle's perimeter D. 4 plus 6 plus 18

18. A taxi charges $4 to start plus $3 per mile. Which equation gives the cost y for x miles? A. $y = 4x + 3$ B. $y = 3x + 4$ C. $y = 7x$ D. $y = 3x - 4$

19. *(Select TWO)* Which statements about the line $y = -3x + 6$ are true? A. The slope is -3 B. The slope is 6 C. The y-intercept is 6 D. The y-intercept is -3

Reporting Category 3 · Geometry and Measurement

20. A cylinder has radius 5 and height 6. What is its volume? ($\pi \approx 3.14$) A. 150 B. 235.5 C. 471 D. 942

21. A sphere has radius 3. What is its volume? ($\pi \approx 3.14$) A. 28.26 B. 84.78 C. 113.04 D. 339.12

22. A cylinder has radius 2 and height 10. What is its **total** surface area? ($\pi \approx 3.14$) A. 125.6 B. 150.72 C. 175.84 D. 251.2

23. *(Griddable)* A right triangle has legs of 9 and 40. What is the length of the hypotenuse? ☐

24. What is the distance between (0, 0) and (6, 8)? A. 7 B. 10 C. 14 D. 48

25. The point $(4, -3)$ is dilated by a scale factor of 2 about the origin. What is the image? A. $(6, -1)$ B. $(8, -6)$ C. $(2, -1.5)$ D. $(8, -3)$

26. The point $(-6, 2)$ is reflected over the x-axis. What is the image? A. $(6, 2)$ B. $(-6, -2)$ C. $(6, -2)$ D. $(2, -6)$

27. The point $(4, 1)$ is rotated 180° about the origin. What is the image? A. $(-4, -1)$ B. $(-1, 4)$ C. $(1, -4)$ D. $(4, -1)$

28. Which transformation **preserves** congruence (keeps the same size)? A. Dilation by factor 2 B. Dilation by factor ½ C. Translation D. Dilation by factor 3

29. Two parallel lines are cut by a transversal. One angle measures 65°. What is its corresponding angle? A. 25° B. 65° C. 115° D. 180°

30. Two similar triangles have corresponding sides in a ratio of 3 : 4. A side of the smaller is 9. What is the matching side of the larger? A. 10 B. 11 C. 12 D. 13

31. The Pythagorean theorem relates the sides of a right triangle by which equation? A. $a + b = c$ B. $a^2 + b^2 = c^2$ C. $a^2 - b^2 = c^2$ D. $2a + 2b = c$

32. A rectangle measures 5 by 3. It is dilated by a scale factor of 2. What is the area of the image? A. 30 B. 45 C. 60 D. 90

Reporting Category 4 · Data Analysis and Personal Financial Literacy

33. *(Griddable)* Find the mean absolute deviation of 4, 8, 10, 14. ☐

34. A trend line is modeled by $y = 3x + 5$. Predict y when $x = 6$. A. 18 B. 20 C. 23 D. 30

35. A scatterplot shows points with no clear pattern or direction. What association is shown? A. Positive linear B. Negative linear C. No association D. Strong linear

36. Which description suggests a **non-linear** association? A. A straight upward line B. A straight downward line C. A curved, U-shaped path D. Points exactly on one line

37. *(Griddable)* Find the simple interest on $1,200 at 6% for 3 years. ☐

38. For the same loan amount and length, how does a **higher** interest rate affect the total cost? A. Lowers it B. Raises it C. No effect D. Cancels the loan

39. Which plan is likely to grow the **most** over time? A. Saving nothing B. Saving a little, once C. Saving small amounts regularly with compound interest D. Spending it all

40. College costs $16,000. A family expects to contribute $6,000 and wants to save the rest over 20 months. How much must they save each month? A. $400 B. $500 C. $600 D. $800

Answers and full explanations for this test are in Part 3 · Answer Keys & Explanations.

Mathematics · Practice Test 3

40 questions · Calculator allowed · Use the Grade 8 Mathematics Reference Sheet

Read each question carefully. Watch for directions like *Select TWO* and *least to greatest*.

Reporting Category 1 · Numerical Representations and Relationships

1. Order from **least to greatest**: 0.6, 62%, ⅝, √0.4. A. 0.6, 62%, ⅝, √0.4 B. √0.4, ⅝, 62%, 0.6 C. 62%, 0.6, ⅝, √0.4 D. ⅝, 0.6, 62%, √0.4

2. Between which two whole numbers does √115 lie? A. 9 and 10 B. 10 and 11 C. 11 and 12 D. 57 and 58

3. *(Griddable)* Write 5,200,000 in scientific notation. ☐

4. Which number is **irrational**? A. √45 B. √49 C. ¾ D. 0.5

Reporting Category 2 · Computations and Algebraic Relationships

5. What is the slope of the line through (−1, −2) and (3, 6)? A. 2 B. 4 C. 8 D. ½

6. A proportional relationship passes through the origin and (4, 10). What is the unit rate? A. 2 B. 2.5 C. 4 D. 6

7. *(Equation editor)* A pool fills at 25 liters per minute, starting empty. Write an equation for the amount y after x minutes. ☐

8. Which relation is a **function**? A. {(3, 1), (3, 2), (4, 5)} B. {(−1, 2), (0, 2), (1, 3)} C. {(2, 4), (2, 5), (3, 6)} D. {(7, 1), (7, 2), (8, 3)}

9. Which equation represents a **non-proportional** relationship? A. y = 5x B. y = ⅓x C. y = 2x − 5 D. y = 8x

10. *(Griddable)* For a direct variation, y = 48 when x = 6. What is y when x = 5? ☐

11. Which table shows a **proportional** relationship? A. (1, 3)(2, 6)(3, 9) B. (1, 2)(2, 5)(3, 8) C. (1, 4)(2, 6)(3, 8) D. (2, 9)(3, 11)(4, 13)

12. *(Griddable)* Solve for x: 9x − 7 = 4x + 18. ☐

13. "Seven less than four times a number equals the number plus eight." Which equation models this? A. 4x − 7 = x + 8 B. 7 − 4x = x + 8 C. 4x + 7 = x − 8 D. 7x − 4 = x + 8

14. Two lines intersect at (4, −1). What is the solution of the system? A. x = −1, y = 4 B. x = 4, y = −1 C. x = 3 D. No solution

15. The slope between any two points on a line is constant because the right triangles formed are — A. congruent B. **similar** C. equilateral D. right isosceles

16. Which situation is **proportional**? A. $30 plus $10 per hour B. 4 pounds of rice per $6, at a steady rate C. 50 L draining 4 L/min D. $12 fee plus $3 each

17. Which situation can be modeled by $6x + 2 = 2x + 22$? A. Two savers start with $2 and $22, saving $6 and $2 per week; when equal? B. 6 times 2 C. A triangle's area D. 2 plus 22

18. A bike rental costs $5 plus $2 per hour. Which equation gives the cost y for x hours? A. $y = 5x + 2$ B. $y = 2x + 5$ C. $y = 7x$ D. $y = 2x - 5$

19. *(Select TWO)* Which statements about $y = 4x - 7$ are true? A. The slope is 4 B. The slope is −7 C. The y-intercept is −7 D. It passes through the origin

Reporting Category 3 · Geometry and Measurement

20. A cylinder has radius 3 and height 10. What is its volume? ($\pi \approx 3.14$) A. 94.2 B. 141.3 C. 282.6 D. 565.2

21. A cone has radius 3 and height 7. What is its volume? ($\pi \approx 3.14$) A. 21.98 B. 65.94 C. 131.88 D. 197.82

22. A cylinder has radius 4 and height 5. What is its **total** surface area? ($\pi \approx 3.14$) A. 125.6 B. 150.72 C. 226.08 D. 351.68

23. *(Griddable)* A right triangle has legs of 8 and 15. Find the hypotenuse. ☐

24. What is the distance between (1, 2) and (5, 5)? A. 5 B. 7 C. 12 D. 25

25. The point (3, −5) is dilated by a scale factor of 2 about the origin. What is the image? A. (5, −3) B. (6, −10) C. (1.5, −2.5) D. (6, −5)

26. The point (−2, −7) is reflected over the y-axis. What is the image? A. (2, −7) B. (−2, 7) C. (2, 7) D. (7, −2)

27. The point (−3, 4) is rotated 180° about the origin. What is the image? A. (3, −4) B. (3, 4) C. (−4, 3) D. (4, −3)

28. A triangle has area 10. It is dilated by a scale factor of 3. What is the area of the image? A. 13 B. 30 C. 90 D. 100

29. An exterior angle of a triangle equals the sum of its two remote interior angles, 40° and 75°. What is the exterior angle? A. 65° B. 105° C. 115° D. 125°

30. Two similar figures have corresponding sides in a ratio of 5 : 8. A side of the smaller is 15. What is the matching side of the larger? A. 18 B. 21 C. 24 D. 27

31. *(Griddable)* The base of a cylinder is a circle with radius 5. What is the base area B? ($\pi \approx 3.14$) ☐

32. Which transformation **changes** the size of a figure? A. Translation B. Reflection C. Rotation D. Dilation by factor 4

Reporting Category 4 · Data Analysis and Personal Financial Literacy

33. *(Griddable)* Find the mean absolute deviation of 5, 7, 9, 11. ☐

34. A trend line is modeled by $y = 2x + 1$. Predict y when $x = 12$. A. 13 B. 23 C. 25 D. 27

35. On a scatterplot, points rise from lower-left to upper-right. What association is shown? A. Positive linear B. Negative linear C. No association D. Non-linear

36. Which pattern suggests the data are **linear**? A. A U-shaped curve B. A circular cluster C. A straight rising path D. Random scatter

37. *(Griddable)* Find the simple interest on $1,500 at 4% for 5 years. ☐

38. For the same amount and rate, which loan length costs the **most** total interest? A. 1 year B. 2 years C. 4 years D. 6 years

39. How do small, regular investments behave over many years? A. Shrink B. Stay equal C. Grow, especially with compound interest D. Disappear

40. College costs $20,000. A family contributes $8,000 and saves the rest over 24 months. How much per month? A. $400 B. $500 C. $600 D. $750

Answers and full explanations for this test are in Part 3 · Answer Keys & Explanations.

Mathematics · Practice Test 4

40 questions · Calculator allowed · Use the Grade 8 Mathematics Reference Sheet

Read each question carefully. Watch for directions like *Select TWO* and *least to greatest*.

Reporting Category 1 · Numerical Representations and Relationships

1. Order from **least to greatest**: ⅞, 0.88, 89%, √0.8. A. ⅞, 0.88, 89%, √0.8 B. √0.8, 89%, 0.88, ⅞ C. 0.88, ⅞, 89%, √0.8 D. 89%, ⅞, 0.88, √0.8

2. Between which two whole numbers does √150 lie? A. 11 and 12 B. 12 and 13 C. 13 and 14 D. 74 and 76

3. *(Griddable)* Write 0.000072 in scientific notation. ☐

4. Which number is **irrational**? A. √24 B. √25 C. ⅖ D. 0.1

Reporting Category 2 · Computations and Algebraic Relationships

5. What is the slope of the line through (−3, 4) and (1, −4)? A. 2 B. −2 C. ½ D. −½

6. A proportional relationship passes through the origin and (6, 9). What is the unit rate? A. 1.5 B. 2 C. 3 D. 6

7. *(Equation editor)* A savings account starts with $40 and grows $15 each week. Write an equation for the balance y after x weeks. ☐

8. Which relation is a **function**? A. {(1, 2), (1, 5), (3, 4)} B. {(2, 3), (4, 3), (6, 5)} C. {(0, 1), (0, 4), (2, 6)} D. {(3, 1), (3, 9), (5, 2)}

9. Which equation represents a **non-proportional** relationship? A. y = 5x + 2 B. y = 6x C. y = ¼x D. y = 9x

10. *(Griddable)* For a direct variation, y = 54 when x = 6. What is y when x = 8? ☐

11. Which table shows a **proportional** relationship? A. (1, 5)(2, 10)(3, 15) B. (1, 3)(2, 7)(3, 11) C. (1, 2)(2, 5)(3, 9) D. (2, 9)(3, 13)(4, 17)

12. *(Griddable)* Solve for x: 8x + 3 = 5x + 27. ☐

13. "Nine more than twice a number equals five times the number minus six." Which equation models this? A. 2x + 9 = 5x − 6 B. 9 − 2x = 5x − 6 C. 2x − 9 = 5x + 6 D. 9x + 2 = 5x − 6

14. Two lines intersect at (−2, −5). What is the solution of the system? A. x = −5, y = −2 B. x = −2, y = −5 C. x = −7 D. No solution

15. The slope of a line is the same everywhere because the right triangles drawn to its points are — A. congruent B. **similar** C. obtuse D. equilateral

16. Which situation is **proportional**? A. $45 plus $20 per hour B. 3 apples for $1.50 at a steady rate C. 60 L losing 6 L/min D. $9 fee plus $4 each

17. Which situation can be modeled by $7x + 5 = 3x + 25$? A. Two savers start with $5 and $25, saving $7 and $3 per week; when equal? B. 7 times 5 C. A circle's area D. 5 plus 25

18. A phone plan costs $10 plus $0.05 per text. Which equation gives the cost y for x texts? A. $y = 10x + 0.05$ B. $y = 0.05x + 10$ C. $y = 10.05x$ D. $y = 0.05x - 10$

19. *(Select TWO)* Which statements about $y = -2x + 8$ are true? A. The slope is -2 B. The slope is 8 C. The y-intercept is 8 D. The y-intercept is -2

Reporting Category 3 · Geometry and Measurement

20. A cylinder has radius 6 and height 5. What is its volume? ($\pi \approx 3.14$) A. 94.2 B. 282.6 C. 565.2 D. 1130.4

21. A sphere has radius 6. What is its volume? ($\pi \approx 3.14$) A. 150.72 B. 452.16 C. 904.32 D. 1808.64

22. A cylinder has radius 5 and height 4. What is its **total** surface area? ($\pi \approx 3.14$) A. 125.6 B. 219.8 C. 282.6 D. 314

23. *(Griddable)* A right triangle has legs of 20 and 21. Find the hypotenuse. ☐

24. What is the distance between $(-2, -1)$ and $(4, 7)$? A. 6 B. 8 C. 10 D. 14

25. The point $(-4, 6)$ is dilated by a scale factor of ½ about the origin. What is the image? A. $(-2, 3)$ B. $(-8, 12)$ C. $(-2, 6)$ D. $(-4, 3)$

26. The point $(3, -8)$ is reflected over the x-axis. What is the image? A. $(-3, -8)$ B. $(3, 8)$ C. $(-3, 8)$ D. $(8, 3)$

27. The point $(5, 2)$ is rotated 90° counterclockwise about the origin. What is the image? A. $(-2, 5)$ B. $(2, -5)$ C. $(-5, -2)$ D. $(2, 5)$

28. The angles of a triangle measure $2x$, $3x$, and $4x$. What is the **largest** angle? A. 20° B. 40° C. 60° D. 80°

29. A rectangle measures 6 by 4. It is dilated by a scale factor of ½. What is the area of the image? A. 3 B. 6 C. 12 D. 24

30. Two similar triangles have corresponding sides in a ratio of 4 : 7. A side of the smaller is 12. What is the matching side of the larger? A. 18 B. 20 C. 21 D. 24

31. In a right triangle, the square on the hypotenuse equals — A. the sum of the squares on the two legs B. the difference of the legs C. twice the longer leg D. the product of the legs

32. Which transformation **preserves** congruence? A. Dilation by factor 2 B. Dilation by factor 3 C. Rotation of 90° D. Dilation by factor ½

Reporting Category 4 · Data Analysis and Personal Financial Literacy

33. *(Griddable)* Find the mean absolute deviation of 6, 10, 10, 14. ☐

34. A trend line is modeled by $y = 0.5x + 3$. Predict y when $x = 20$. A. 10 B. 13 C. 16 D. 23

35. A scatterplot shows points with no clear direction or pattern. What association is shown? A. Positive linear B. Negative linear C. No association D. Strong linear

36. Which pattern suggests a **non-linear** association? A. A straight rising line B. A straight falling line C. A curved path D. Points on one line

37. *(Griddable)* Find the simple interest on $2,000 at 3% for 6 years. ☐

38. Two accounts hold the same amount at the same rate for the same time. Which earns **more**? A. The simple-interest account B. The compound-interest account C. They earn the same D. Neither earns interest

39. What helps savings grow the most over time? A. Spending it quickly B. Saving once, then stopping C. Regular saving plus compound interest D. Keeping cash at home

40. College costs $24,000. A family contributes $9,000 and saves the rest over 30 months. How much per month? A. $450 B. $500 C. $600 D. $750

Answers and full explanations for this test are in Part 3 · Answer Keys & Explanations.

Part 2 · Reading Language Arts

How Grade 8 RLA Is Built

The Grade 8 Reading Language Arts test has about **45 questions worth 56 points** in two sections, plus written responses. This book teaches **every reading and writing skill the test measures.**

Section	What It Covers	On the Test
Reading	Vocabulary, comprehension, literary elements, genres, author's craft; includes **2 Short Constructed Responses**	~28 Q / ~30 pts
Writing — Revising & Editing	Organizing and improving writing; grammar and conventions; includes **1 Extended Constructed Response**	~17 Q / ~26 pts

Three Kinds of Tasks

1. **Multiple-choice and tech-enhanced questions** about passages you read.
2. **Short Constructed Responses (SCR)** — a few written sentences with text evidence (2 points each).
3. **Extended Constructed Response (ECR)** — a full essay (10 points), tied to a reading passage.

Genres You Will Read

- **Literary:** fiction, literary nonfiction, poetry, drama
- **Informational / argumentative:** informational, argumentative, persuasive
- **In revising & editing:** correspondence (letters, emails)

> **Key Idea:** Reading STAAR is not about memorizing stories — it is about **using evidence.** Almost every question can be answered by pointing to a specific place in the text. Read closely and back up every answer with proof.

Genre Guide

STAAR passages come from many genres, and each has its own features to notice. Knowing the genre tells you what to look for. (Standards 8A–8E.)

Literary Genres

- **Fiction ○ (8A)** — made-up stories: realistic, historical, mystery, adventure, humor, fantasy, science fiction, short stories. *Notice:* characters, setting, conflict, plot, theme.
- **Literary Nonfiction** — true stories told with literary craft (memoir, personal essay). *Notice:* the real experience and its message.
- **Poetry ○ (8B)** — lines and stanzas; forms include epic, lyric, humorous. *Notice:* **graphical elements** such as line length and punctuation, plus rhythm, rhyme, imagery.
- **Drama ○ (8C)** — plays organized in **acts and scenes** with dialogue and stage directions. *Notice:* how acts and scenes move the action.

Informational and Argumentative Genres

- **Informational (8D)** — explains a topic. *Notice:* the **controlling idea/thesis** with evidence ★; features like **footnotes, endnotes, citations** ○; the **organizational pattern** ○.
- **Argumentative (8E)** — makes a claim and defends it. *Notice:* the **claim** ★, the **counter-argument** ★, and the **intended audience** ○.
- **Persuasive** — tries to convince. *Notice:* appeals, word choice, calls to action.

For Revising & Editing

- **Correspondence** — letters and emails, friendly or business. *Notice:* greeting, purpose, tone, closing.

> **Strategy:** The first thing to ask about any passage is *"What genre is this, and what is its purpose?"* A story wants you to follow characters and theme; an argument wants you to weigh a claim and its evidence.

Reading Strategy Lessons

These lessons teach the reading skills STAAR tests again and again. Each is tagged with its TEKS and marked ★ **Readiness** or ○ **Supporting**.

Part A · Vocabulary (2A ○, 2B ★, 2C ○)

- **2B · Context clues** ★ — Read the words around an unfamiliar word: definitions, examples, synonyms, antonyms, and the sentence's sense point to the meaning.
- **2A · Reference tools** ○ — A dictionary/glossary gives meaning, syllables, pronunciation, origin, part of speech. (A dictionary is available on the real test.)
- **2C · Greek & Latin roots** ○ — **ast** (star → astronomy), **qui** (rest → tranquil), **path** (feeling → sympathy), **mand/mend** (order → command), **duc** (lead → conduct).

Worked example. "The *arid* desert had not seen rain in years." *Arid* = very dry — the context shows it. **Try It.** "His *gregarious* nature made him the center of every party." *(Outgoing/sociable.)*

Part B · Comprehension (5C ○, 5E ★, 5F ★, 5G ★, 5H ★)

- **5F · Inference + evidence** ★ — A smart conclusion from text clues + prior knowledge; always find the supporting words.
- **5G · Key ideas** ★ — Separate the main point from small details. **5H · Synthesize** ★ — Combine ideas (one text or across two) into new understanding.
- **5E · Make connections** ★ — Link text to other texts, the world, and experience. **5C · Predictions** ○ — Predict from genre and features, then confirm or correct.

Worked example. A character "slammed the door and refused to speak" → **infer** she is angry; the evidence is her actions. **Try It.** Sky darkens, wind rises, people hurry indoors → *a storm is coming.*

Part C · Response to Reading (6C ★, 6D ★)

- **6C · Text evidence** ★ — Support every answer with a specific word, phrase, or sentence. This is the heart of STAAR reading.
- **6D · Paraphrase & summarize** ★ — Restate in your own words (paraphrase) or give a short, ordered version of the main points (summarize), keeping meaning accurate.

Strategy: For "Which sentence **best** supports…?" decide your answer first, then find the line that *directly* proves it — not one that is merely true.

Part D · Literary Elements (7A ○, 7B ★, 7C ★, 7D ○)

- **7B · Character motivation** ★ — Why characters act, and how that drives events and the conflict's resolution.
- **7C · Non-linear plot** ★ — **Flashback**, **foreshadowing**, subplots, parallel plots — vs. straight linear order.

- **7A · Theme** ○ — The message, developed through characters and events. **7D · Setting** ○ — When/where, and how it shapes values and beliefs.

Try It. A story opens at a funeral, then jumps back to the character's childhood. What device? *(Flashback.)*

Part E · Author's Purpose and Craft (9A ★, 9B–9G ○)

- **9A · Purpose & message** ★ — To inform, persuade, or entertain — and the message within.
- **9B · Text structure** ○ — Cause–effect, compare–contrast, sequence, problem–solution. **9C · Print/graphic features** ○ — Headings, captions, charts, and why.
- **9D · Figurative language** ○ — Simile, metaphor (incl. extended metaphor), personification. **9E · Devices** ○ — Irony and multiple points of view.
- **9F · Mood, voice, tone** ○ — The feeling, the author's personality, the attitude toward the subject. **9G · Rhetoric & fallacies** ○ — Analogy, juxtaposition; bandwagon, circular reasoning.

Worked example (tone). "cramped, gloomy, endless" → a **negative, heavy tone.** **Try It.** "Everyone is switching to BrightSmile — don't be left behind!" Which fallacy? *(Bandwagon appeal.)*

Reading Skills Checklist

- ☐ 2A–C Vocabulary · ☐ 5C–H Comprehension · ☐ 6C–D Response
- ☐ 7A–D Literary elements · ☐ 9A–G Author's craft

Revising and Editing Refresher

In the Writing section you fix and improve short passages. **Revising** makes writing clearer and better organized; **editing** corrects grammar and conventions. (Standards 10B, 10C, 10D.)

Revising — Making Writing Better (10B ★, 10C ★)

- **10B · Structure & development ★** — A strong piece has an **introduction, transitions, coherent paragraphs, and a conclusion** (10B·i) and develops ideas with **specific facts, details, examples** (10B·ii).
- **10C · Revising for quality ★** — Improve **clarity, development, organization, style, word choice, and sentence variety.** Combine choppy sentences; cut repetition; choose precise words.

Worked example. "The dog was big. The dog was loud. The dog ran." → "The big, loud dog ran across the yard." (sentence variety)

Editing — Correcting Conventions (10D)

- **10D·i · Complete sentences ★** — Complete sentences with **subject-verb agreement**; avoid run-ons, comma splices, fragments.
- **10D·ii · Verb tense & voice ★** — Keep tenses consistent; use active/passive voice correctly.
- **10D·iii · Prepositions ○** — Use correctly; don't let them confuse subject-verb agreement. **10D·iv · Pronoun-antecedent ○** — Match pronoun to noun in number and gender.
- **10D·v · Capitalization ○** **10D·vi · Punctuation ○** — Commas in nonrestrictive phrases/clauses, **semicolons, colons, parentheses.**
- **10D·vii · Spelling ★** — Including confusables: **its/it's, affect/effect, there/their/they're, to/two/too.**

Worked example (agreement). "The box of markers *are* on the desk." → subject is *box* (singular): "The box of markers **is** on the desk." (the phrase *of markers* doesn't change the subject)

> **Watch Out:** *Its* = belonging to it; *it's* = it is. *Their* = belonging to them; *there* = a place; *they're* = they are. Tested often.

Try It. Fix: "Me and him walked to there house." → *(He and I walked to their house.)*

Short Constructed Response (SCR) Mastery

The Reading section includes **2 Short Constructed Responses**, each worth **2 points.** You write a few sentences that answer a question and back it up with **evidence from the text.** (Builds on response standards 6C and 6D.)

Score	What it means
2	A **correct, clear answer** fully supported with **accurate text evidence** and a brief explanation
1	A partially correct answer, or weak/vague/incomplete evidence
0	An incorrect answer, no text evidence, or blank/off-topic

Key Idea: Two points = **answer + evidence + explanation.** Leaving out the evidence is the most common way students lose a point.

The A-E-E Structure

1. Answer the question directly. **2. Evidence** — quote or paraphrase a specific detail. **3. Explain** how it supports your answer. Stems: *The text shows that… · For example, the author writes "…" · This proves that…*

Worked Example

Prompt: *How does the narrator feel about moving to a new town? Use evidence from the text.*

Full credit (2): The narrator feels **nervous and sad** about moving. The text says she "stared at the empty walls of her old room and felt her stomach tighten." This shows she is anxious because her familiar home is gone. *— clear answer + quotation + explanation.*

Partial (1): The narrator feels bad about moving because she doesn't want to go. *— reasonable, but no text evidence or explanation.*

No credit (0): I would feel excited to move to a new place. *— personal opinion, not the narrator's feelings; no evidence.*

Strategy: Keep it to three or four focused sentences. Always include one specific detail or short quotation. Answer the exact question asked — don't drift into your own opinion unless the prompt asks for it.

Extended Constructed Response (ECR) Mastery

The Writing section includes **1 Extended Constructed Response** — a full multi-paragraph essay worth **10 points**, tied to a reading passage. It is the single biggest-point task on the RLA test.
(Composition standards 11B informational, 11C argumentative, 11D correspondence; and 6B comparing sources.)

What the Essay Must Have

- A clear **central idea or claim** (thesis).
- **Coherent organization** — introduction, body paragraphs, conclusion.
- **Sufficient development** — specific **evidence** and explanation, not general statements.
- **Effective language and conventions** — varied sentences, precise words, correct grammar.

> **Key Idea:** Points come from a clear thesis, organized paragraphs, and **specific evidence** explained in your own words. A blank or one-paragraph answer cannot score high.

A 4-Step Essay Plan

1. **Plan (2–3 min).** Decide your thesis; jot 2–3 supporting points and the evidence for each.
2. **Introduction.** Hook + topic + **thesis/claim.**
3. **Body paragraphs (2–3).** One point each: state it → give **evidence** → **explain** it. Use transitions.
4. **Conclusion.** Restate the thesis in fresh words; leave a final thought.

Argumentative tip: Name the **counter-argument** and answer it ("Some may say…, but…").

Annotated Sample (Argumentative, shortened)

Prompt: *Should students have longer recess?*

Many schools are cutting recess, but students actually learn better with more of it. *(claim)* First, recess gives the brain a break. The article states that "students who move during the day focus longer in class." *(evidence)* This shows play is not wasted time. *(explanation)* In addition, recess builds friendships and reduces stress. Some argue recess takes away learning minutes, **but** rested students finish work faster. *(counter-argument answered)* For these reasons, schools should give students longer recess. *(conclusion)*

Score band	What it looks like
High (8–10)	Clear thesis, well organized, specific evidence explained, strong conventions

Middle (4–7)	A thesis and some organization, but thin evidence or several errors
Low (1–3)	Unclear or missing thesis, little development, many errors
0	Blank, off-topic, or too brief to score

Strategy: Plan for a couple of minutes before writing — an organized essay almost always scores higher than a longer, messy one. Always use **evidence from the passage**, and leave a minute to check spelling and punctuation.